QUANTUS INSIGHTS

STATEWIDE SURVEY OF LIKELY VOTERS · GENERAL ELECTION

# North Carolina U.S. Senate Survey

The Cooper and Whatley ballot, the two-candidate ballot, candidate favorability and the 2024 baseline among likely voters, with change since the September wave.

| FIELDED | RESPONDENTS | POPULATION | MARGIN OF ERROR |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| October 24 to 25, 2026 | 722 | Likely voters | ±4.0 |

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

# Core findings

**51.4 to 42.8**

Cooper to Whatley, U.S. Senate ballot, race voters

01

## Cooper leads the Senate ballot by 8.6

Roy Cooper takes 51.4 percent to Michael Whatley's 42.8 among respondents who would vote in the race, with 3.4 percent undecided. The margin on a difference between two candidates is about ±8.0, so the lead sits at the edge of the survey's uncertainty. With leaners allocated the ballot is 52.4 to 43.4, Cooper +9.0.

02

## The two-candidate ballot gives the same answer

With the minor candidates removed, Cooper leads 53.2 to 44.1 among race voters, a 9.1 point margin; on the full base, including the 2.8 percent who would not vote, it is 51.7 to 42.9. With leaners the two-candidate ballot is 53.9 to 44.5, Cooper +9.4.

03

## The margin has widened since September

On the same voters-only basis, the September wave had Cooper 49.8 to 44.6, a 5.3 point lead. Cooper is up 1.6 and Whatley down 1.8, a net shift of 3.3 toward Cooper. The change is inside the margin on a wave-to-wave difference, but the ballot, the two-candidate ballot and favorability all moved the same way.

04

## Cooper's image improved; Whatley's held

Cooper is 53.4 favorable to 44.4 unfavorable, net +9.0, up from +5.2 in September. Whatley is 41.8 to 47.4, net -5.5, little changed from -6.4, with 10.8 percent holding no opinion or unaware of him. Opinion of Cooper is polarized: 39.4 very favorable against 40.4 very unfavorable.

05

## Unaffiliated voters and women carry the lead

Registered unaffiliated voters back Cooper 55 to 36 and women 55 to 39; men are even at 47 to 48. Partisans hold at 94 percent Cooper among Democrats and 89 Whatley among Republicans. Urban voters go Cooper 68 to 26 and rural voters Whatley 59 to 37.

06

## An electorate that recalls Trump +3

Respondents recall voting Trump 48.1 to Harris 44.8, a 3.3 point edge against the certified 3.2, so the sample looks like the 2024 electorate. On that electorate Cooper runs about 12 points ahead of the 2024 presidential margin. Published averages put the race at Cooper +7 to +12; this survey sits inside that range.

METHODOLOGY

# How this survey was conducted

## POPULATION

The survey represents likely voters in the 2026 North Carolina general election. A likely voter screen, calibrated to turnout scores from the Quantus Insights turnout model, was used to define and weight the survey population, drawing on voting history, demographics, partisan lean indicators and voter file geography.

## FIELD PERIOD

October 24 to 25, 2026. The prior wave was fielded September 21 to 22, 2026 with the same instrument and weighting design.

## SAMPLING

Stratified random sampling from the eligible universe, matched to available contact records.

## MARGIN OF ERROR

±4.0 percentage points at the 95 percent confidence level, design adjusted, for the analytical sample of 722. The design effect is 1.19, resulting in an effective sample size of approximately 613. Subgroup margins are larger. The margin on the difference between two candidates is roughly twice the single share margin, about ±8.0. Conditional follow ups do not carry the full sample margin.

## ROUNDING

Percentages may not total 100 due to rounding. Full precision is retained in the underlying results; margins are computed from unrounded shares.

## UNIVERSE

Active registered North Carolina voter file records. Respondents were contacted through SMS invitations sent to mobile phones. The pre-screen reporting base is 746; 24 respondents (3.1 percent) who said they would not vote are excluded from analysis, leaving an analytical likely voter base of 722 lot questions are reported among respondents who would vote in the race (Q1 n=722, Q3 n=703); the two leaner follow ups run on the 24 and 20 respondents undecided on each ballot.

## MODE

SMS to mobile cell interviews.

## WEIGHTING

Iterative proportional fitting, or raking, to benchmarks for the North Carolina likely general election electorate on seven dimensions: sex, age range, education, metro type, congressional district, race and ethnicity (reported) and party registration. Weights were trimmed to limit the influence of individual respondents and renormalized each iteration. Uncertainty was additionally assessed with 400 re-raked bootstrap replicates.

## REPORTING

Topline results are shown to one decimal; crosstab cells are whole number column percentages within each subgroup. Base n is shown on every table. Cells marked * rest on fewer than 80 respondents and are directional only. Party is the voter file registration field; race and ethnicity are respondent reported; metro type and media market are voter file geography.

The survey intelligence pipeline that processes each study is described on the next page. For questions or inquiries email contact@quantusinsights.org or visit quantusinsights.org.

QUANTUS INSIGHTS

METHODOLOGY

# Survey intelligence pipeline

Quantus Insights processes each study through a multi-stage survey intelligence pipeline that evaluates sample composition, coverage, geographic balance, and statistical stability.

## 01

### BENCHMARKS AND WEIGHTS

The pipeline applies the study's likely voter criteria and weighting benchmarks, monitors the distribution and influence of survey weights, and evaluates convergence with the intended electorate.

## 02

### RESPONSE BIAS AUDIT

Because respondents are drawn from the voter file, the pipeline also audits who within each demographic, partisan and geographic cell responded, comparing reported prior cycle vote against certified results to detect response bias that demographic raking cannot.

## 03

### CALIBRATION AND STABILITY

Where indicated, final weights are calibrated to official prior cycle returns; calibration targets come from certified election results, never from the survey's own recall distribution. Effective sample size, subgroup stability, missing data patterns and response propensity checks against the universe are reviewed throughout.

## 04

### EXPERT OVERSIGHT

Statistical automation is paired with expert methodological oversight to validate data quality, confirm the appropriate use of variables and benchmarks, and identify irregularities requiring further review. This combination provides a rigorous and consistent framework for producing estimates representative of the defined survey population.

How this study was processed: the pipeline's checks run on the prescreen reporting base of 746 before any result in this report is produced. The reported design effect of 1.19 and effective sample size of 613 are outputs of that review. The recall audit is on the 2024 baseline pages: the sample recalls Trump +3.3 against the certified Trump +3.2 statewide result, a tenth of a point apart.

QUANTUS INSIGHTS

SAMPLE COMPOSITION

# Reporting composition

**746**

reporting base, pre screen

| GENDER | % | |
|---|---|---|
| Women | **53.8** | n=401 |
| Men | **46.2** | n=345 |

| AGE | % | |
|---|---|---|
| 18 to 29 | **11.5** | n=86 |
| 30 to 44 | **21.2** | n=158 |
| 45 to 64 | **36.9** | n=275 |
| 65+ | **30.4** | n=227 |

| PARTY REGISTRATION | % | |
|---|---|---|
| Republican | **33.2** | n=248 |
| Unaffiliated | **35.0** | n=261 |
| Democrat | **31.8** | n=237 |

| RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED) | % | |
|---|---|---|
| White | **69.2** | n=516 |
| Black | **18.0** | n=134 |
| Hispanic or Latino | **5.8** | n=43 |
| Other | **5.8** | n=43 |
| Asian | **1.3** | n=10 |

| METRO TYPE | % | |
|---|---|---|
| Rural | **37.4** | n=279 |
| Urban | **29.8** | n=222 |
| Suburban | **23.7** | n=177 |
| Town | **9.1** | n=68 |

| EDUCATION | % | |
|---|---|---|
| HS to some college | **59.7** | n=445 |
| College | **24.8** | n=185 |
| Graduate school | **15.5** | n=116 |

| REGION | % | |
|---|---|---|
| Charlotte/West | **35.6** | n=266 |
| Raleigh–Durham | **30.8** | n=230 |
| Central | **18.4** | n=137 |
| Coastal | **15.2** | n=113 |

Counts are the pre screen reporting base of 746. The ballots, favorability and 2024 recall run on the 722 analytical likely voters after the 23 who said they would not vote are removed; the ballots additionally exclude respondents who would not vote in the race (Q1 n=722, Q3 n=703). Shares are weighted to the seven methodology benchmarks. Party is voter file registration; race and ethnicity are respondent reported.

Regions group the nine media markets. Charlotte/West is the Charlotte, Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville and Chattanooga markets; Raleigh–Durham is the Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market; Central is Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem; Coastal is Greenville-New Bern-Washington, Wilmington, Norfolk-Portsmouth-Newport News and Myrtle Beach-Florence. Regional results combine the market crosstabs, weighting each market by its respondent count, so they can differ by a point from a direct tabulation.

TOPLINE SUMMARY

# The Senate ballot at a glance

The full ballot and the two-candidate ballot among the state's likely voters, each with its leaner follow up, in percent. Full results, favorability and demographic detail follow.

## Q1 · U.S. SENATE · RACE VOTERS · N=722

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 51.4 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 42.8 |
| Undecided | 3.4 |
| Shannon Bray (L) | 1.3 |
| Michael Dublin (G) | 0.7 |
| Someone else | 0.4 |

## Q3 · TWO-CANDIDATE · FULL BASE · N=722

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 51.7 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 42.9 |
| Would not vote in this race | 2.8 |
| Undecided | 2.6 |

## Q3 · TWO-CANDIDATE · RACE VOTERS · N=703

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 53.2 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 44.1 |
| Undecided | 2.7 |

## MARGIN, DECIDED SHARE AND LEANERS

| | |
|---|---|
| As asked (Q1) | Cooper +8.6 |
| Decided share, Cooper | 54.6 |
| Decided share, Whatley | 45.4 |
| With leaners (Q2) | 52.4 to 43.4 |
| Margin with leaners | Cooper +9.0 |

## MARGIN, DECIDED SHARE AND LEANERS

| | |
|---|---|
| As asked (Q3), full base | Cooper +8.8 |
| Decided share, Cooper | 54.7 |
| Decided share, Whatley | 45.3 |
| Would not vote in this race | 2.8 |
| Undecided | 2.6 |

## MARGIN, DECIDED SHARE AND LEANERS

| | |
|---|---|
| As asked (Q3), race voters | Cooper +9.1 |
| Decided share, Cooper | 54.7 |
| Decided share, Whatley | 45.3 |
| With leaners (Q4) | 53.9 to 44.5 |
| Margin with leaners | Cooper +9.4 |

Analytical base 722 likely voters · October 24 to 25, 2026 · design adjusted margin of error ±4.0. Election voter bases exclude respondents who would not vote in this election. Percentages may not total 100 due to rounding. Decided shares divide each candidate's vote by the two candidate total. Leaners are allocated from each ballot's follow up (n=24 and 20). Margins with leaners are from the report's combined ballots.

SECTION ONE

# The U.S. Senate ballot

The Cooper and Whatley ballot and the two-candidate ballot, each with demographic detail and how undecided voters lean when pushed, plus the ballot by region.

**QUESTIONS**

Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4

**STRUCTURE**

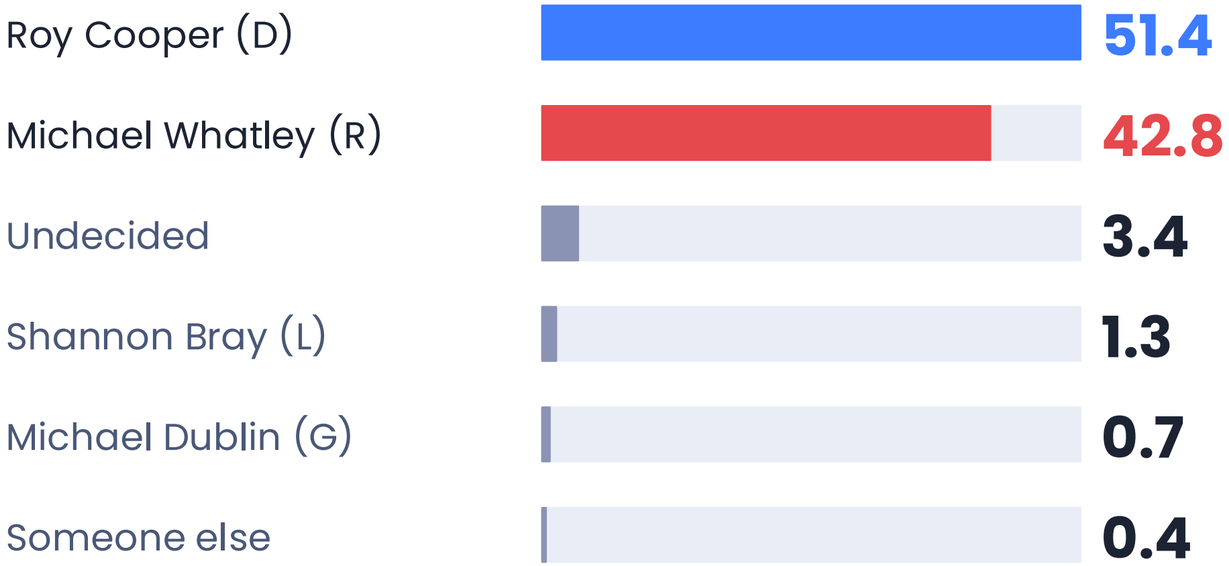
Topline, ballot with leaners, demographic and regional detail

**BASES**

n = 722 race voters (Q1); n = 703 (Q3); n = 24 and 20 leaners

Q1 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT

# If the election for U.S. Senate in North Carolina were held today, for whom would you vote?




## Cooper +8.6

Cooper margin over Whatley, race voters

### TWO WAY SHARE OF DECIDED VOTERS




**54.6** percent of the decided vote for Cooper; 45.4 for Whatley

### LEADER AND MARGIN BY GROUP

| | |
|---|---|
| Women | Cooper +16 |
| Men | Whatley +1 |
| Unaffiliated | Cooper +19 |
| Democrats | Cooper +91 |
| Republicans | Whatley +82 |
| Suburban | Cooper +14 |
| Urban | Cooper +42 |
| Rural | Whatley +22 |

### THE MARGIN

Cooper leads Whatley by 8.6 points. The margin on a difference between two candidates is about ±8.0, so the lead sits at the edge of the survey's uncertainty. Cooper takes 54.6 percent of the decided vote with 3.4 percent of race voters undecided.

### THE REST OF THE BALLOT

3.4 percent are undecided, the Libertarian Shannon Bray takes 1.3, the Green Michael Dublin 0.7 and 0.4 percent name someone else. The 24 respondents who would not vote in the race are excluded. With leaners allocated the ballot is Cooper 52.4, Whatley 43.4.

### REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the 722 race voter base. Group margins are the leader's lead over the runner up in whole number column percentages. Decided share divides each candidate by the two candidate total. Party is voter file registration.

Q1 + Q2 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT WITH LEANERS

# The Senate ballot as asked, and with undecided voters pushed to lean

**Cooper +9.0**

Cooper margin over Whatley with leaners allocated

## Q1 · INITIAL BALLOT · N=722

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 51.4 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 42.8 |
| Undecided | 3.4 |
| Shannon Bray (L) | 1.3 |
| Michael Dublin (G) | 0.7 |
| Someone else | 0.4 |

## Q1 + Q2 · WITH LEANERS · N=722

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 52.4 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 43.4 |
| Still undecided | 1.8 |
| Shannon Bray (L) | 1.2 |
| Michael Dublin (G) | 0.8 |
| Someone else | 0.4 |

## Q2 · HOW THE UNDECIDED BROKE · N=24

If you had to choose among the following candidates, for whom would you vote? Asked of respondents who were undecided on Q1.

| | |
|---|---|
| Still undecided | 54.3 |
| Roy Cooper, the Democrat | 24.3 |
| Michael Whatley, the Republican | 16.6 |
| Michael Dublin, the Green | 4.9 |
| Shannon Bray, the Libertarian | 0.0 |

## MARGIN, INITIAL AND WITH LEANERS

| | |
|---|---|
| Initial ballot (Q1) | Cooper +8.6 |
| With leaners allocated | Cooper +9.0 |
| Cooper share with leaners | 52.4 |
| Whatley share with leaners | 43.4 |

### THE PUSH

Of the 3.4 percent who were undecided, 24 percent lean Cooper, 17 percent lean Whatley and 5 percent lean Dublin; 54 percent stay undecided. The follow up base is 24; treat the split as directional.

### WHAT IT DOES TO THE BALLOT

Allocating leaners adds 1.0 to Cooper and 0.6 to Whatley: 52.4 to 43.4 with 1.8 percent still undecided. The Cooper lead widens slightly, from 8.6 as asked to 9.0 with leaners.

### REPORTING NOTE

Initial ballot on the 722 race voter base. Leaners are allocated to each candidate in proportion to the Q2 shares and added to the initial ballot; the still undecided remain undecided. Minor candidate and someone else responses are unchanged except for the leaners added.

Q1 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

# If the election for U.S. Senate in North Carolina were held today, for whom would you vote?

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **GENDER** | | | | |
| Women | **55** | 39 | 6 | 388 |
| Men | 47 | **48** | 5 | 334 |
| **AGE** | | | | |
| 18 to 29 | **56** | 35 | 9 | 80 |
| 30 to 44 | **58** | 34 | 8 | 152 |
| 45 to 64 | **51** | 43 | 6 | 268 |
| 65+ | 45 | **51** | 4 | 222 |
| **EDUCATION** | | | | |
| HS to some college | 46 | **48** | 6 | 427 |
| College | **58** | 38 | 4 | 181 |
| Graduate school | **61** | 32 | 7 | 114 |

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED)** | | | | |
| White | 45 | **52** | 3 | 500 |
| Black | **80** | 11 | 9 | 131 |
| Hispanic or Latino* | **63*** | 28* | 9* | 41 |
| Asian* | **63*** | 32* | 5* | 10 |
| Other* | 28* | **50*** | 22* | 40 |
| **PARTY REGISTRATION** | | | | |
| Unaffiliated | **55** | 36 | 9 | 248 |
| Republican | 7 | **89** | 4 | 240 |
| Democrat | **94** | 3 | 3 | 234 |

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **METRO TYPE** | | | | |
| Rural | 37 | **59** | 4 | 266 |
| Urban | **68** | 26 | 6 | 214 |
| Suburban | **53** | 39 | 8 | 176 |
| Town* | **51*** | 42* | 7* | 66 |
| **REGION** | | | | |
| Charlotte/West | **50** | 45 | 5 | 256 |
| Raleigh–Durham | **59** | 33 | 8 | 218 |
| Central | 47 | 47 | 6 | 136 |
| Coastal | 45 | **51** | 4 | 112 |

## GENDER AND AGE

Women back Cooper 55 to 39 and men split 47 to 48. Voters under 65 go Cooper by 8 to 24 points; seniors go Whatley 51 to 45. College graduates are Cooper +20 and graduate degree holders +29; the HS to some college group splits 48 Whatley to 46 Cooper.

## PARTY AND PLACE

Democrats go Cooper 94 to 3 and Republicans Whatley 89 to 7; unaffiliated voters go Cooper 55 to 36. Urban voters are Cooper +42, suburban voters +14 and rural voters Whatley +22. Black voters go Cooper 80 to 11 and white voters Whatley 52 to 45.

## REPORTING NOTE

Whole number column percentages on the 722 race voter base. Other = undecided, Bray, Dublin and someone else. * = base under 80, directional. Regions combine the media market crosstabs weighted by respondent count. Party is voter file registration.

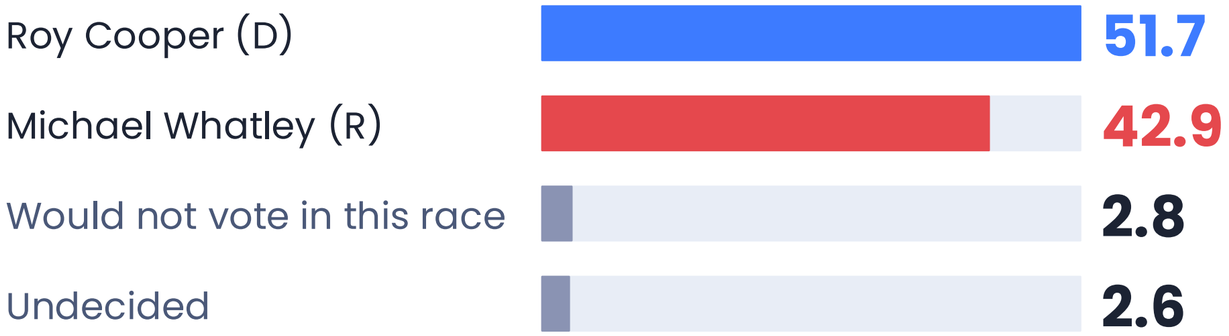
Q3 · TWO-CANDIDATE BALLOT

## If the election for U.S. Senate were just between the following two candidates, for whom would you vote?

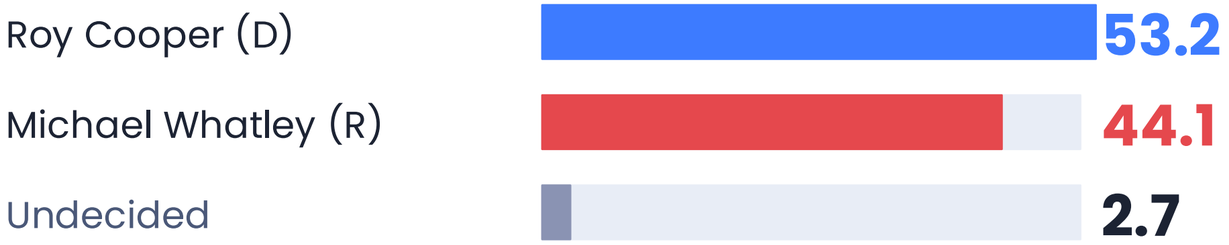
# Cooper +9.1

Cooper margin over Whatley, race voters

FULL BASE · N=722




RACE VOTERS ONLY · N=703




### TWO WAY SHARE OF DECIDED VOTERS




**54.7** percent of the decided vote for Cooper; 45.3 for Whatley

### LEADER AND MARGIN BY GROUP · RACE VOTERS

| | |
|---|---|
| Women | Cooper +15 |
| Men | Cooper +2 |
| Unaffiliated | Cooper +20 |
| Democrats | Cooper +92 |
| Republicans | Whatley +83 |
| Suburban | Cooper +18 |
| Urban | Cooper +41 |
| Rural | Whatley +19 |

### THE MARGIN

With the minor candidates removed, Cooper leads 53.2 to 44.1 among race voters, a 9.1 point margin against the full ballot's 8.6. On the full analytical base of 722, including the 2.8 percent who would not vote in the race, the ballot is 51.7 to 42.9.

### THE REST OF THE BALLOT

2.7 percent of race voters are undecided. With leaners allocated the two-candidate ballot is Cooper 53.9, Whatley 44.5. Men move from a point behind on the full ballot to Cooper +2 here; every other group holds its full ballot lean.

### REPORTING NOTE

Race voter base excludes 20 respondents who would not vote in this race; crosstabs use that base. Group margins are the leader's lead in whole number column percentages. Decided share divides each candidate by the two candidate total.

Q3 + Q4 · TWO-CANDIDATE BALLOT WITH LEANERS

# The two-candidate ballot as asked, and with undecided voters pushed to lean

**Cooper +9.4**

Cooper margin over Whatley with leaners allocated

## Q3 · INITIAL BALLOT · RACE VOTERS · N=702

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 53.2 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 44.1 |
| Undecided | 2.7 |

## Q3 + Q4 · WITH LEANERS · N=702

| | |
|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | 53.9 |
| Michael Whatley (R) | 44.5 |
| Still undecided | 1.6 |

## Q4 · HOW THE UNDECIDED BROKE · N=20

If you had to choose between the following two candidates, for whom would you vote? Asked of respondents who were undecided on Q3.

| | |
|---|---|
| Still undecided | 57.1 |
| Roy Cooper, the Democrat | 27.3 |
| Michael Whatley, the Republican | 15.6 |

## MARGIN, INITIAL AND WITH LEANERS

| | |
|---|---|
| Initial ballot (Q3) | Cooper +9.1 |
| With leaners allocated | Cooper +9.4 |
| Cooper share with leaners | 53.9 |
| Whatley share with leaners | 44.5 |

## THE PUSH

Of the 2.7 percent who were undecided, 27 percent lean Cooper and 16 percent lean Whatley; 57 percent stay undecided. The follow up base is 20; treat the split as directional.

## WHAT IT DOES TO THE BALLOT

Allocating leaners adds 0.7 to Cooper and 0.4 to Whatley: 53.9 to 44.5 with 1.6 percent still undecided. The Cooper lead widens from 9.1 as asked to 9.4 with leaners.

## REPORTING NOTE

Initial ballot on the 703 race voter base. Leaners are allocated in proportion to the Q4 shares and added to the initial ballot; the still undecided remain undecided. The report's combined ballot tracks 19 of the 20 follow up respondents.

Q3 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

# If the election for U.S. Senate were just between the following two candidates, for whom would you vote?

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | UNDEC. | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **GENDER** | | | | |
| Women | **56** | 41 | 3 | 376 |
| Men | **50** | 48 | 3 | 327 |
| **AGE** | | | | |
| 18 to 29 | **67** | 29 | 3 | 80 |
| 30 to 44 | **61** | 35 | 4 | 144 |
| 45 to 64 | **51** | 47 | 2 | 263 |
| 65+ | 45 | **52** | 3 | 216 |
| **EDUCATION** | | | | |
| HS to some college | 48 | **49** | 3 | 417 |
| College | **58** | 40 | 2 | 175 |
| Graduate school | **66** | 32 | 2 | 111 |

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | UNDEC. | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED)** | | | | |
| White | 46 | **52** | 2 | 488 |
| Black | **81** | 15 | 4 | 126 |
| Hispanic or Latino* | **61*** | 35* | 4* | 40 |
| Asian* | **64*** | 36* | 0* | 9 |
| Other* | 45* | **52*** | 2* | 40 |
| **PARTY REGISTRATION** | | | | |
| Unaffiliated | **57** | 37 | 5 | 240 |
| Republican | 8 | **91** | 1 | 235 |
| Democrat | **95** | 3 | 1 | 228 |

| GROUP | COOPER | WHATLEY | UNDEC. | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **METRO TYPE** | | | | |
| Rural | 39 | **58** | 3 | 262 |
| Urban | **69** | 28 | 3 | 209 |
| Suburban | **58** | 40 | 2 | 168 |
| Town* | 46* | **50*** | 3* | 64 |
| **REGION** | | | | |
| Charlotte/West | **52** | 46 | 2 | 251 |
| Raleigh–Durham | **62** | 33 | 5 | 212 |
| Central | 49 | **50** | 1 | 131 |
| Coastal | 45 | **54** | 1 | 109 |

## HEAD TO HEAD

With the minor candidates gone, men tilt to Cooper 50 to 48 and women hold at 56 to 41. Voters under 45 are Cooper +26 to +38; seniors stay Whatley 52 to 45. The HS to some college group is even at 48 to 49.

## PARTY AND PLACE

Unaffiliated voters go Cooper 57 to 37; Democrats hold at 95 percent and Republicans at 91. Urban voters are Cooper +41, suburban voters +18 and rural voters Whatley +19.

## REPORTING NOTE

Whole number column percentages on the 703 race voter base. * = base under 80, directional. Regions combine the media market crosstabs weighted by respondent count. Party is voter file registration.

Q1 + Q3 · REGIONAL DETAIL

# The Senate ballot by region

## Q1 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT · RACE VOTERS

| | CHARLOTTE/WEST<br>Charlotte · Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville · Chattanooga markets<br>n=256 | RALEIGH–DURHAM<br>Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market<br>n=218 | CENTRAL<br>Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem market<br>n=136 | COASTAL<br>Greenville-New Bern · Wilmington · Norfolk · Myrtle Beach markets<br>n=112 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | **50** | **59** | **47** | **45** |
| Michael Whatley (R) | **45** | **33** | **47** | **51** |
| Undecided | 2 | 5 | 5 | 1 |

## Q3 · TWO-CANDIDATE BALLOT · RACE VOTERS

| | CHARLOTTE/WEST<br>Charlotte · Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville · Chattanooga markets<br>n=251 | RALEIGH–DURHAM<br>Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market<br>n=212 | CENTRAL<br>Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem market<br>n=131 | COASTAL<br>Greenville-New Bern · Wilmington · Norfolk · Myrtle Beach markets<br>n=109 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Roy Cooper (D) | **52** | **62** | **49** | **45** |
| Michael Whatley (R) | **46** | **33** | **50** | **54** |
| Undecided | 2 | 5 | 1 | 1 |

### THE TWO BIG REGIONS

Raleigh–Durham carries the statewide lead: Cooper 59 to 33, a 26 point margin on a third of the sample. Charlotte/West is much closer, Cooper 50 to 45, with the Charlotte market itself at 51 to 45.

### CENTRAL AND COASTAL

The Triad is even at 47 apiece on the full ballot and 50 Whatley to 49 Cooper head to head. The coast goes Whatley 51 to 45 on a base of 112; read it with care.

### REPORTING NOTE

Whole number column percentages within each region. Regions combine the nine media market crosstabs, weighting each market by its respondent count, so a cell can differ by a point from a direct tabulation. * = base under 80.

SECTION TWO

# Candidate favorability

How the state's likely voters view Michael Whatley and Roy Cooper: the six point scale, the combined favorable and unfavorable shares, and net favorability by group and region.

**QUESTIONS**

Q5, Q6

**STRUCTURE**

Two candidate comparison, then net favorability by group and by region

**BASES**

n = 722 likely voters for each item

Q5 TO Q6 · CANDIDATE FAVORABILITY

# Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of each candidate?

**Cooper +9.0**

net favorable; Whatley -5.5

## Michael Whatley (R)

**-5.5**

net unfavorable



**41.8 favorable** — **47.4 unfavorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Very favorable | **22.7** |
| Somewhat favorable | **19.1** |
| Somewhat unfavorable | **12.6** |
| Very unfavorable | **34.8** |
| Heard of, no opinion | **6.7** |
| Never heard of | **4.1** |

## Roy Cooper (D)

**+9.0**

net favorable



**53.4 favorable** — **44.4 unfavorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Very favorable | **39.4** |
| Somewhat favorable | **13.9** |
| Somewhat unfavorable | **3.9** |
| Very unfavorable | **40.4** |
| Heard of, no opinion | **1.5** |
| Never heard of | **0.7** |

### INTENSITY

Cooper's image is hard on both sides: 39.4 percent very favorable against 40.4 very unfavorable, with under 18 percent in the soft middle. Whatley's is softer, 22.7 very favorable against 34.8 very unfavorable, with 32 percent somewhat either way.

### NAME RECOGNITION

Only 2.2 percent hold no view of Cooper, a former two term governor. 10.8 percent hold no view of Whatley, including 4.1 percent who have never heard of him; in September the figure was 9.4. Cooper is +22 with unaffiliated voters; Whatley is -17 with them.

### REPORTING NOTE

Each item on the 722 likely voter base, margin of error ±4.0. Favorable and unfavorable combine the very and somewhat responses. Net = favorable minus unfavorable, computed from the one decimal topline shares.

Q5 TO Q6 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

# Net favorability by group: favorable minus unfavorable, in points

| GROUP | WHATLEY | COOPER | N |
|---|---|---|---|
| **GENDER** | | | |
| Women | -13 | +15 | 389 |
| Men | +5 | +1 | 334 |
| **AGE** | | | |
| 18 to 29 | -23 | +6 | 83 |
| 30 to 44 | -24 | +26 | 153 |
| 45 to 64 | +1 | +14 | 267 |
| 65+ | +6 | -9 | 220 |
| **EDUCATION** | | | |
| HS to some college | -11 | +10 | 431 |
| College | +9 | +7 | 179 |
| Graduate school | -7 | +10 | 113 |

| GROUP | WHATLEY | COOPER | N |
|---|---|---|---|
| **RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED)** | | | |
| White | 0 | -4 | 500 |
| Black | -32 | +66 | 130 |
| Hispanic or Latino* | +19* | +34* | 42 |
| Asian* | -67* | +62* | 10 |
| Other* | +1* | -44* | 41 |
| **PARTY REGISTRATION** | | | |
| Unaffiliated | -17 | +22 | 253 |
| Republican | +52 | -66 | 240 |
| Democrat | -52 | +73 | 230 |

| GROUP | WHATLEY | COOPER | N |
|---|---|---|---|
| **METRO TYPE** | | | |
| Rural | +12 | -23 | 270 |
| Urban | -23 | +40 | 215 |
| Suburban | -9 | +27 | 172 |
| Town* | -11* | -4* | 66 |
| **REGION** | | | |
| Charlotte/West | -6 | +12 | 258 |
| Raleigh–Durham | -27 | +26 | 223 |
| Central | +9 | +3 | 133 |
| Coastal | +21 | -23 | 109 |

## PARTY

Cooper is +73 with Democrats and -66 with Republicans; Whatley is +52 with Republicans and -62 with Democrats. Unaffiliated voters are +22 on Cooper and -17 on Whatley, matching their 55 to 36 ballot.

## PLACE AND AGE

Cooper is +40 in the cities and +27 in the suburbs but -23 in rural areas, where Whatley is +12, his only net positive place type. Voters 30 to 44 are Cooper +26; seniors are Cooper -9 and Whatley +6. The under 30 cell is Cooper +6 and Whatley -23.

## REPORTING NOTE

Net = favorable minus unfavorable in whole number column percentages within each subgroup, so a net can differ by a point from the topline. * = base under 80, directional. Regions combine the market crosstabs weighted by respondent count.

Q5 + Q6 · REGIONAL DETAIL

# Candidate favorability by region

## Q5 · MICHAEL WHATLEY FAVORABILITY

| | CHARLOTTE/WEST<br>Charlotte · Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville · Chattanooga markets<br>n=258 | RALEIGH–DURHAM<br>Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market<br>n=223 | CENTRAL<br>Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem market<br>n=133 | COASTAL<br>Greenville-New Bern · Wilmington · Norfolk · Myrtle Beach markets<br>n=109 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Very favorable | 19 | 21 | 29 | 26 |
| Somewhat favorable | 19 | 12 | 22 | 31 |
| Somewhat unfavorable | 13 | 17 | 5 | 13 |
| Very unfavorable | 31 | 43 | 37 | 23 |
| Net favorable | -6 | -27 | +9 | +21 |

## Q6 · ROY COOPER FAVORABILITY

| | CHARLOTTE/WEST<br>Charlotte · Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville · Chattanooga markets<br>n=258 | RALEIGH–DURHAM<br>Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market<br>n=223 | CENTRAL<br>Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem market<br>n=133 | COASTAL<br>Greenville-New Bern · Wilmington · Norfolk · Myrtle Beach markets<br>n=109 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Very favorable | 37 | 43 | 45 | 32 |
| Somewhat favorable | 18 | 17 | 7 | 6 |
| Somewhat unfavorable | 4 | 4 | 1 | 7 |
| Very unfavorable | 39 | 30 | 48 | 54 |
| Net favorable | +12 | +26 | +3 | -23 |

### RALEIGH–DURHAM AND CHARLOTTE/WEST

Cooper is 60 favorable to 34 unfavorable in Raleigh–Durham and 55 to 43 in Charlotte/West; Whatley is 33 to 60 and 38 to 44.

### CENTRAL AND COASTAL

In the Triad, Cooper is 52 to 49 and Whatley 51 to 42. On the coast Cooper is 38 to 61 and Whatley 57 to 36, the one region where Cooper is net negative.

### REPORTING NOTE

No opinion and never heard rows omitted. Whole number column percentages; regions combine the media market crosstabs weighted by respondent count. * = base under 80, directional.

SECTION THREE

# Change since September

The October wave against the September 21 to 22 wave: the ballot, the two-candidate ballot, favorability and the groups that moved. Same instrument, same weighting design.

**QUESTIONS**

Q1, Q3, Q5, Q6

**STRUCTURE**

Wave to wave comparison on matching bases, then by group

**BASES**

September n = 686 (±4.2); October n = 722 (±4.0); ballots on race voters

SEPTEMBER TO OCTOBER · BALLOT AND FAVORABILITY

# Cooper's lead widened on both ballots; his favorability improved while Whatley's held

**+3.3**

net shift to Cooper since September, voters only ballot

## SENATE BALLOT · VOTERS ONLY

Sept n = 666 · Oct n = 722

**Cooper (D)**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 49.8 |
| Oct | **51.4** |

**Whatley (R)**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 44.6 |
| Oct | **42.8** |

| SEPTEMBER | OCTOBER |
|---|---|
| +5.3 | **+8.6** |

Cooper margin

## TWO-CANDIDATE · FULL BASE

Sept n = 686 · Oct n = 722

**Cooper (D)**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 48.7 |
| Oct | **51.7** |

**Whatley (R)**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 43.5 |
| Oct | **42.9** |

| SEPTEMBER | OCTOBER |
|---|---|
| +5.2 | **+8.8** |

Cooper margin

## COOPER FAVORABILITY

full base

**Favorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 50.8 |
| Oct | **53.4** |

**Unfavorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 45.6 |
| Oct | **44.4** |

| SEPTEMBER | OCTOBER |
|---|---|
| +5.2 | **+9.0** |

net favorability

## WHATLEY FAVORABILITY

full base

**Favorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 42.1 |
| Oct | **41.8** |

**Unfavorable**

| | |
|---|---|
| Sept | 48.5 |
| Oct | **47.4** |

| SEPTEMBER | OCTOBER |
|---|---|
| -6.4 | **-5.5** |

net favorability

Cooper is up 1.6 points and Whatley down 1.8 on the voters only ballot since September, and the two-candidate ballot moved by about the same amount, 5.2 to 8.8. Undecided is essentially unchanged at three to four percent, so the movement is between the candidates rather than out of the undecided pool. Both waves use the same instrument and weighting design; the September ballot is rebased to voters only (would not vote removed) to match the October reporting base.

### THE BALLOT

Cooper 49.8 to 44.6 in September, 51.4 to 42.8 now. The 3.3 point net shift is inside the roughly ±11 margin on a wave to wave change, but every indicator moved the same way, and the lead moved from inside the margin on a difference to its edge.

### FAVORABILITY

Cooper's net moved from +5.2 to +9.0, with favorable up 2.6 and unfavorable down 1.2. Whatley's net moved from -6.4 to -5.5, a change inside the margin, while his no view share rose from 9.4 to 10.8.

### REPORTING NOTE

September figures are from the September 21 to 22 wave, n=686, ±4.2. Margins are computed from unrounded shares; the September voters only ballot removes the 2.9 percent who said they would not vote in the race.

SEPTEMBER TO OCTOBER · BY GROUP

# Cooper's margin on the full ballot, September and October, by group

| GROUP | SEPT | OCT | CHANGE | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **STATEWIDE · RACE VOTERS** | | | | |
| Topline | C +5.3 | C +8.6 | +3.3 C | 722 |
| **GENDER** | | | | |
| Women | C +14 | C +16 | +2 C | 388 |
| Men | W +5 | W +1 | +4 C | 334 |
| **AGE** | | | | |
| 18 to 29 | C +21 | C +21 | 0 | 80 |
| 30 to 44 | C +16 | C +24 | +8 C | 152 |
| 45 to 64 | C +5 | C +8 | +3 C | 268 |
| 65+ | W +10 | W +6 | +4 C | 222 |
| **EDUCATION** | | | | |
| HS to some college | W +5 | W +2 | +3 C | 427 |
| College | C +18 | C +20 | +2 C | 181 |
| Graduate school | C +19 | C +29 | +10 C | 114 |

| GROUP | SEPT | OCT | CHANGE | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED)** | | | | |
| White | W +13 | W +7 | +6 C | 500 |
| Black | C +71 | C +69 | +2 W | 131 |
| **PARTY REGISTRATION** | | | | |
| Unaffiliated | C +16 | C +19 | +3 C | 248 |
| Republican | W +84 | W +82 | +2 C | 240 |
| Democrat | C +90 | C +91 | +1 C | 234 |
| **MEDIA MARKET** | | | | |
| Raleigh-Durham | C +24 | C +26 | +2 C | 218 |
| Charlotte | C +3 | C +6 | +3 C | 199 |
| Greensboro | W +1 | Even | +1 C | 136 |

| GROUP | SEPT | OCT | CHANGE | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **METRO TYPE** | | | | |
| Rural | W +30 | W +22 | +8 C | 266 |
| Urban | C +28 | C +42 | +14 C | 214 |
| Suburban | C +10 | C +14 | +4 C | 176 |
| Town* | W +6 | C +9 | +15 C | 66 |

## WHERE IT MOVED

The largest shifts are among urban voters (+14 to Cooper), graduate degree holders (+11), rural voters (+8) and white voters (+6). Men went from Whatley +5 to a point behind; the HS to some college group from Whatley +5 to Whatley +2.

## WHERE IT HELD

Black voters, Democrats, Republicans, college graduates and the three big media markets are all within three points of September. No group of reportable size moved toward Whatley.

## REPORTING NOTE

Whole number subgroup margins; the topline row is from unrounded shares. September cells include the 2.9 percent who would not vote in the race; October cells are on race voters. Subgroup changes carry wide margins. * = base under 80.

SECTION FOUR

# North Carolina in context

The four regions this report uses, how the state has voted in statewide races since 2008, and where this survey sits against the published polling averages and ratings.

**QUESTIONS**

Q1 in context

**STRUCTURE**

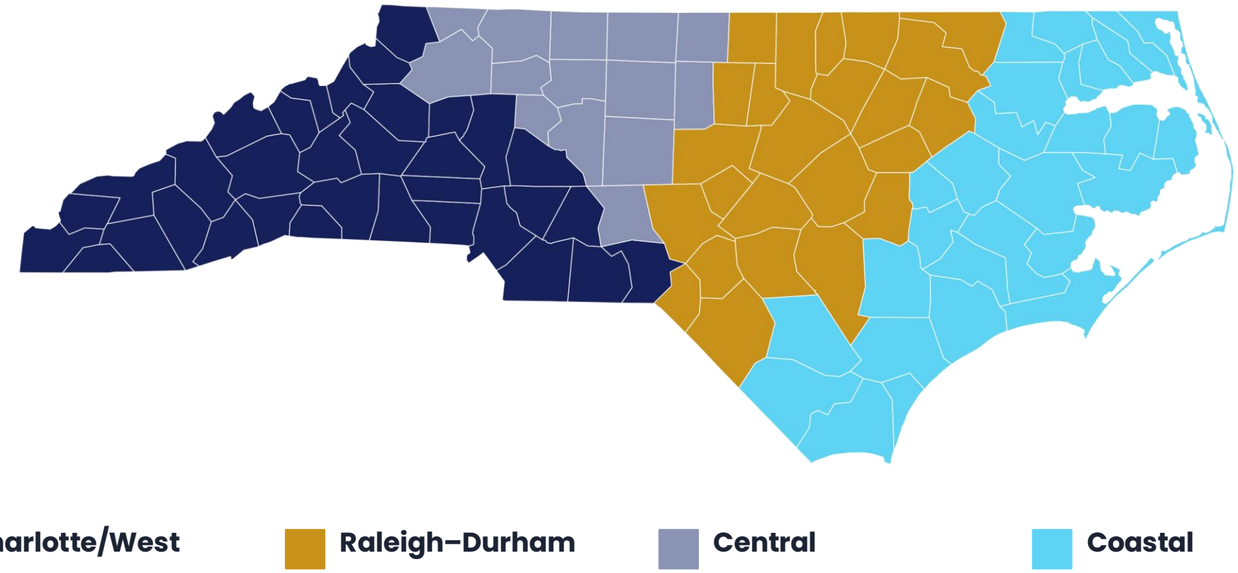
Regional map, statewide results 2008 to 2024, published averages

**BASES**

Certified returns, NC State Board of Elections; polling averages as of October 26, 2026

THE STATE'S REGIONS

# Four regions built from the nine media markets




## SHARE OF SAMPLE AND SENATE BALLOT

**Charlotte/West**
Charlotte · Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville · Chattanooga markets
35.6% of sample · n=266
Cooper 50 · Whatley 45
**Cooper +5**

**Raleigh–Durham**
Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market
30.8% of sample · n=230
Cooper 59 · Whatley 33
**Cooper +26**

**Central**
Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem market
18.4% of sample · n=137
Cooper 47 · Whatley 47
**Even**

**Coastal**
Greenville-New Bern · Wilmington · Norfolk · Myrtle Beach markets
15.2% of sample · n=113
Cooper 45 · Whatley 51
**Whatley +6**

### WHY REGIONS

Six of the nine media markets rest on 60 or fewer respondents, so market cells are directional at best. Four regions put every region but the coast above the 80 respondent threshold while keeping the state's political geography.

### WHAT THE MAP SHOWS

Charlotte/West: the Charlotte, Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville and Chattanooga markets. Raleigh–Durham: the Raleigh-Durham (Fayetteville) market. Central: Greensboro-High Point-Winston Salem. Coastal: Greenville-New Bern, Wilmington, Norfolk and Myrtle Beach.

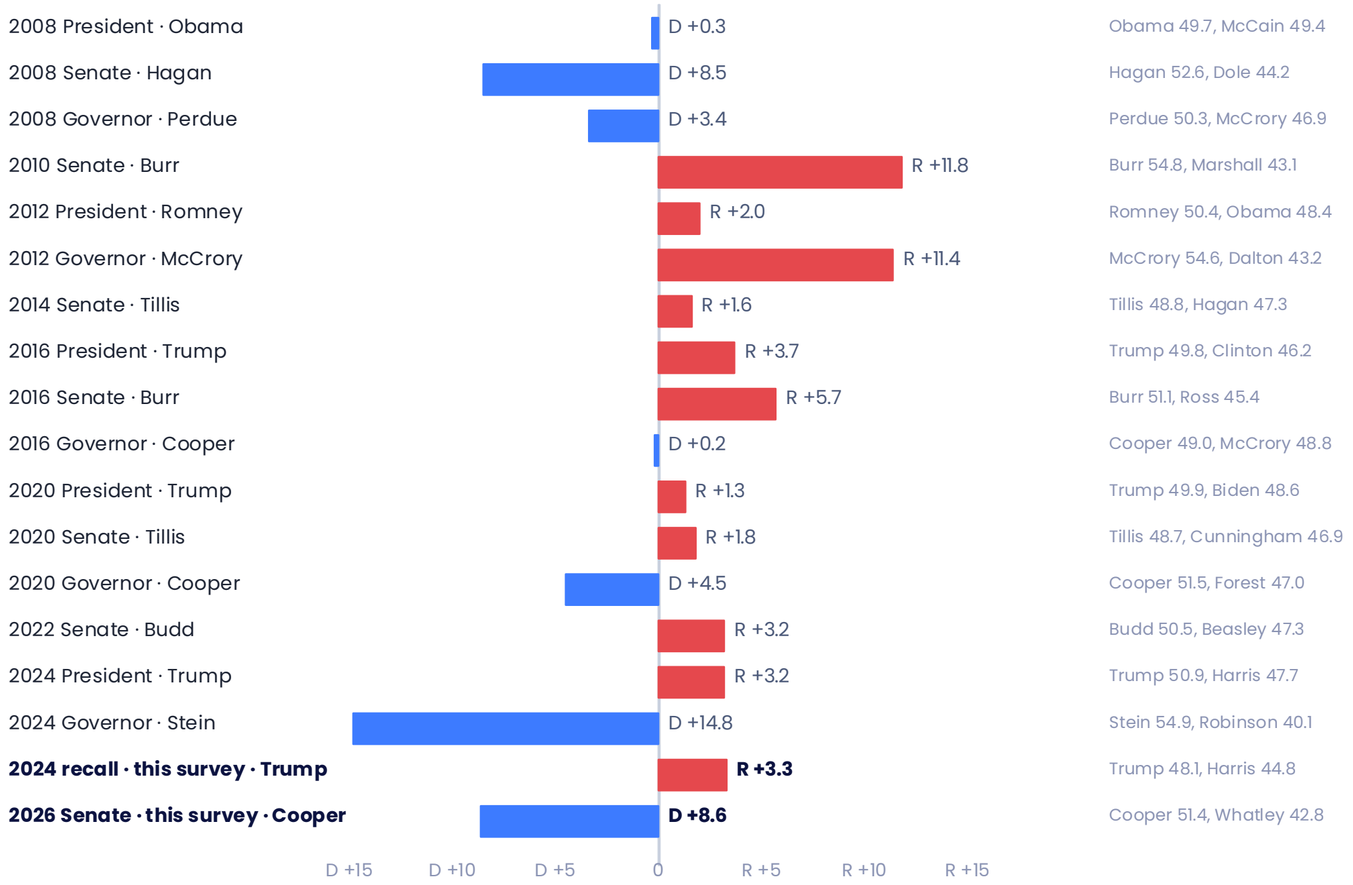
### REPORTING NOTE

County shading approximates Nielsen media market boundaries. Regional results combine the market crosstabs weighted by respondent count. Sample shares on the prescreen base of 746; ballot figures are Q1 among race voters. * = base under 80.

ELECTORAL HISTORY

# Republicans have won every Senate race since 2010; Democrats have kept the Governor's office

## STATEWIDE MARGIN, WINNING PARTY, POINTS




## HOW TO READ THE RECORD

North Carolina has been the closest state in the country at the presidential level since 2008: Obama carried it by three tenths of a point, and the four Republican wins since have averaged 2.6 points. No Democrat has won a Senate race since Kay Hagan in 2008; the last three Senate contests were decided by 1.6, 1.8 and 3.2 points.

The state splits its ticket. Democrats have won four of the last five Governor's races, three of them by Roy Cooper and Josh Stein, and Cooper's 2016 win came on the same ballot that gave Trump the state by 3.7.

This survey's respondents recall Trump +3.3, a tenth of a point off the certified 2024 result. On that electorate Cooper leads by 8.6, about 12 points better than the 2024 presidential margin and more than any Senate candidate of either party has won by since 2010.

Sources: certified returns from the North Carolina State Board of Elections, as compiled by Wikipedia and 270toWin; margins are computed from the certified two candidate shares before rounding, so a margin can differ by a tenth from the rounded shares shown. Survey rows are this study: 2024 recall on the 722 analytical base, 2026 Senate on the 722 race voter base, margin of error ±4.0.

PUBLISHED POLLING

# The published averages put the race at Cooper +7 to +12; this survey sits inside that range

## POLLING AVERAGES · AS OF OCTOBER 26, 2026



| | | |
|---|---|---|
| RealClearPolling average<br>9/27 to 10/20 · 9 polls | 50.7<br>40.1 | Cooper +10.6 |
| Decision Desk HQ average<br>current average | 51.2<br>44.1 | Cooper +7.1 |
| FiftyPlusOne average<br>as of Oct 26 | 51.2<br>41.6 | Cooper +9.6 |
| 270toWin average<br>last five polls | 52.8<br>41.0 | Cooper +11.8 |
| **Quantus Insights · this survey**<br>Oct 24 to 25 · race voters, n=722 | 51.4<br>42.8 | Cooper +8.6 |
| **Quantus Insights · September**<br>Sept 21 to 22 · all likely voters, n=686 | 48.4<br>43.3 | Cooper +5.1 |

## RECENT PUBLIC POLLS · OCTOBER

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Harper Polling (Carolina Journal)<br>10/18 to 10/20 · 600 LV | 49 to 39 | C +10 | YouGov<br>to 10/20 · 560 LV | 54 to 43 | C +11 |
| ActiVote<br>to 10/20 · 400 LV | 57 to 43 | C +14 | Change Research (Carolina Forward)<br>10/1 to 10/7 · 829 LV | 50 to 40 | C +10 |
| SurveyUSA (WRAL-TV)<br>10/1 to 10/7 · 643 LV | 54 to 40 | C +14 | Trafalgar Group<br>10/8 to 10/10 · 1,091 LV | 49 to 41 | C +8 |
| Elon University<br>9/29 to 10/8 · 565 LV | 52 to 39 | C +13 | East Carolina University<br>9/30 to 10/3 · 810 LV | 50 to 43 | C +7 |

## WHAT THE FIELD SAYS

Every public poll of the race since July has had Cooper ahead, by 4 to 15 points. The four published averages span Cooper +7.1 (Decision Desk HQ) to +11.8 (270toWin's five poll average), with RealClearPolling at +10.6 and FiftyPlusOne at +9.6.

This survey's Cooper +8.6 sits inside that range, toward its lower half, as the September wave's +5.1 sat at the low end of the field then. The difference is mostly in Whatley's share: this survey has him at 42.8, against 40 to 41 in most of the averages, with fewer undecided.

Race ratings: the Cook Political Report moved the race off its Toss Up list in April 2026 and Sabato's Crystal Ball moved it from Toss Up to Leans Democratic on June 11, 2026.

Sources: RealClearPolling (Cooper vs. Whatley, two way average, 9/27 to 10/20), Decision Desk HQ race page, FiftyPlusOne and 270toWin averages and poll listings, all read October 26, 2026; NC Newsline on the Cook and Sabato rating changes. Public poll figures are as listed by the aggregators and rounded to whole numbers; Quantus figures are from this study and the September wave.

SECTION FIVE

# The 2024 baseline

How the sample recalls its 2024 presidential vote against the certified statewide result, by group and by region. Recall is a diagnostic on sample composition, not a weighting target.

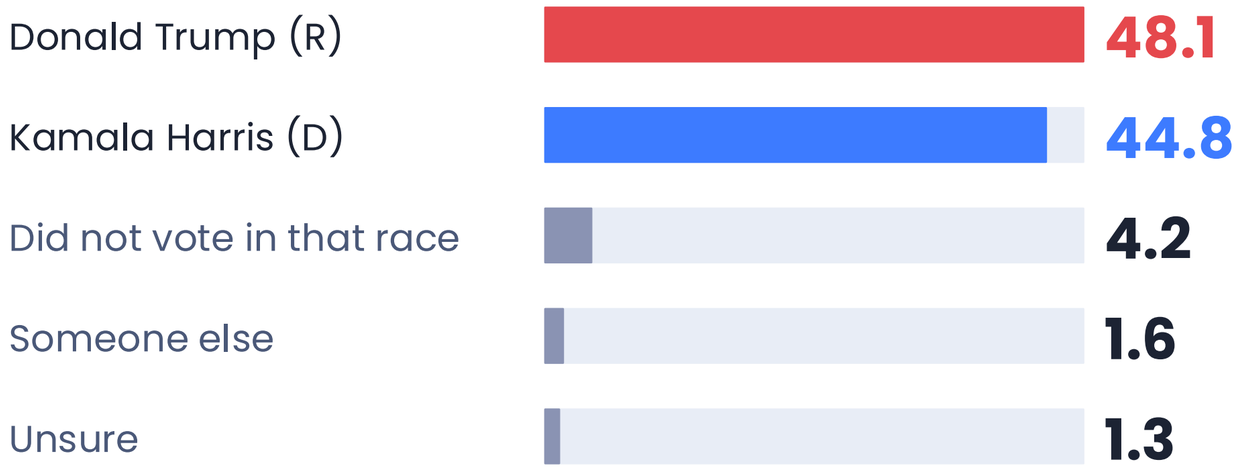
**QUESTIONS**
Q7

**STRUCTURE**
Recall topline, demographic and regional detail

**BASES**
n = 722 likely voters

Q7 · 2024 PRESIDENTIAL VOTE RECALL

## In the 2024 election for President, did you vote for Republican Donald Trump, Democrat Kamala Harris, someone else, did you not vote in that race, or are you unsure?




# Trump +3.3

Trump margin, recalled 2024 vote

### TWO WAY SHARE, RECALLED VOTE




**3.3** point margin, Trump, recalled 2024 vote; Trump +3.2 in the certified result (50.9 to 47.7)

### RECALLED MARGIN BY GROUP

| | |
|---|---|
| Women | Harris +3 |
| Men | Trump +11 |
| Unaffiliated | Trump +5 |
| Democrats | Harris +88 |
| Republicans | Trump +89 |
| Suburban | Trump +4 |
| Urban | Harris +36 |
| Rural | Trump +30 |

### THE BASELINE

Respondents recall a Trump +3.3 vote, against the certified Trump +3.2 statewide: a tenth of a point apart. In September the recalled margin was Trump +1.9, so this wave's sample sits closer to the 2024 result than the last one did.

### WHAT IT MEANS

The ballot runs on an electorate that recalls 2024 almost exactly. On that electorate Cooper leads by 8.6, about 12 points better than Harris did; unaffiliated voters recall Trump +5 and back Cooper +19, a 24 point swing. Recall was not a weighting target.

### REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the 722 likely voter base. 7.1 percent did not vote, voted for someone else or are unsure. Certified result: NC State Board of Elections, 2024 general election, shares of the total vote.

Q7 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

# In the 2024 election for President, did you vote for Republican Donald Trump, Democrat Kamala Harris, someone else, did you not vote in that race, or are you unsure?

| GROUP | TRUMP | HARRIS | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **GENDER** | | | | |
| Women | 45 | **48** | 7 | 389 |
| Men | **52** | 41 | 7 | 334 |
| **AGE** | | | | |
| 18 to 29 | **50** | 41 | 9 | 83 |
| 30 to 44 | 40 | **51** | 9 | 153 |
| 45 to 64 | 47 | **48** | 5 | 267 |
| 65+ | **55** | 38 | 7 | 220 |
| **EDUCATION** | | | | |
| HS to some college | **55** | 40 | 5 | 431 |
| College | 41 | **49** | 10 | 179 |
| Graduate school | 33 | **55** | 12 | 113 |

| GROUP | TRUMP | HARRIS | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RACE / ETHNICITY (REPORTED)** | | | | |
| White | **57** | 37 | 6 | 500 |
| Black | 11 | **80** | 9 | 130 |
| Hispanic or Latino* | 46* | 46* | 8* | 42 |
| Asian* | **57*** | 32* | 11* | 10 |
| Other* | **60*** | 33* | 7* | 41 |
| **PARTY REGISTRATION** | | | | |
| Unaffiliated | **47** | 42 | 11 | 253 |
| Republican | **92** | 3 | 5 | 240 |
| Democrat | 4 | **92** | 4 | 230 |

| GROUP | TRUMP | HARRIS | OTHER | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **METRO TYPE** | | | | |
| Rural | **61** | 31 | 8 | 270 |
| Urban | 28 | **64** | 8 | 215 |
| Suburban | **49** | 45 | 6 | 172 |
| Town* | **60*** | 36* | 4* | 66 |
| **REGION** | | | | |
| Charlotte/West | 41 | **50** | 9 | 258 |
| Raleigh–Durham | 44 | **47** | 9 | 223 |
| Central | **58** | 40 | 2 | 133 |
| Coastal | **61** | 35 | 4 | 109 |

### CROSSOVER

3 percent of registered Republicans recall a Harris vote and 4 percent of Democrats a Trump vote. Unaffiliated voters recall Trump 47 to 42; women recall Harris 48 to 45 and men Trump 52 to 41.

### BALLOT VS. RECALL

Unaffiliated voters recall Trump +5 but back Cooper +19 on the Senate ballot, a 24 point swing. Suburban voters recall Trump +4 and back Cooper +14; rural voters recall Trump +30 and back Whatley +22.

### REPORTING NOTE

Whole number column percentages on the 722 base. Other = did not vote, someone else and unsure. * = base under 80, directional. Regions combine the market crosstabs weighted by respondent count.

BASES AND MARGIN OF ERROR

# What each number can carry

| ANALYSIS BASE | 95% MARGIN OF ERROR | REPORTABLE |
|---|---|---|
| 722 analytical base | **±4.0 pts** | Yes |
| 300 to 400 | **±5.3 to ±6.2 pts** | Yes |
| 150 to 250 | **±6.8 to ±8.7 pts** | Yes, with base |
| 80 to 149 | **±8.8 to ±12.0 pts** | Yes, read with care |
| Under 80 | **wider than ±12.0 pts** | Directional only (*) |

Margins are calculated at the 95 percent confidence level for an estimate near 50 percent and include the survey design effect of 1.19. Conditional follow up questions do not use the full sample margin of error. Subgroups marked with an asterisk should be interpreted as directional. The margin on a difference between two candidates is roughly ±8.0; the margin on a change in that difference between two waves is larger still, roughly ±11.

## QUESTION BASES

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q1 · U.S. Senate ballot, race voters | **n=722** | Q2 · Senate leaners | **n=24** |
| Q3 · Two-candidate ballot, full base / race voters | **n=722 / 703** | Q4 · Two-candidate leaners | **n=20** |
| Q5 · Whatley favorability | **n=722** | Q6 · Cooper favorability | **n=722** |
| Q7 · 2024 presidential vote recall | **n=722** | Screened reporting base | **n=746** |

## SMALL BASES IN THIS WAVE

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hispanic or Latino**<br>Race / ethnicity (reported) · Q1 | **n=41** |
| **Asian**<br>Race / ethnicity (reported) · Q1 | **n=10** |
| **Other**<br>Race / ethnicity (reported) · Q1 | **n=40** |
| **Town**<br>Metro type · Q1 | **n=66** |
| **Greenville-New Bern-Washington**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=60** |
| **Greenville-Spartanburg-Asheville**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=50** |
| **Wilmington**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=34** |
| **Norfolk-Portsmouth-Newport News**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=11** |
| **Myrtle Beach-Florence**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=7** |
| **Chattanooga**<br>Media market · Q1 | **n=4** |
| **Coastal region (four markets combined)**<br>Region · Q1 · read with care | **n=112** |
| **Undecided follow ups**<br>Q2, Q4 · directional only | **n=24 / 20** |

## WHO IS IN THE BASE

Favorability and recall run on the 722 who passed the vote likelihood screen. Q1 and Q3 additionally exclude respondents who would not vote in that race; Q2 and Q4 were asked only of the undecided on each ballot.

## DIFFERENCES

The margin on a difference between two candidates is roughly ±8.0. Cooper +8.6 on the full ballot and +9.1 head to head sit at its edge; the 3.3 point change since September is inside the wave to wave margin.

## REPORTING NOTE

Design effect 1.19; effective sample size 613. Cells under 80 are flagged * and are directional. Uncertainty additionally assessed with 400 re raked bootstrap replicates.

AT A GLANCE

# The headline figures

## Cooper +8.6

U.S. Senate ballot, race voters; 51.4 to 42.8

## Cooper +9.0

Ballot with leaners allocated; 52.4 to 43.4

## Cooper +9.1

Two-candidate ballot, race voters; 53.2 to 44.1, +9.4 with leaners

## +3.3

Net shift to Cooper since September on the voters only ballot; +5.3 to +8.6

## +9.0

Cooper net favorable; 53.4 to 44.4, up from +5.2 in September

## -5.5

Whatley net favorable; 41.8 to 47.4, with 10.8 percent holding no view

## Cooper +19

Unaffiliated voters on the Senate ballot; 55 to 36

## Trump +3.3

Recalled 2024 vote; Trump +3.2 in the certified result

### A COOPER LEAD AT THE EDGE OF THE MARGIN

Cooper leads by 8.6 with 3.4 percent undecided, on an electorate that recalls Trump +3.3, a tenth off the certified 2024 result. The two-candidate ballot and both leaner treatments land between +9.0 and +9.4. The lead sits at the edge of the ±8.0 margin on a difference and has widened by 3.3 since September.

### WHERE THE RACE TURNS

Unaffiliated voters, a third of the electorate, back Cooper 55 to 36 while recalling a Trump vote. Women are Cooper +16 and men a point apart. Urban voters are Cooper +42, suburban +14, rural Whatley +22. The published averages run from Cooper +7 to +12; this survey is inside that range.

### REPORTING NOTE

Margins are computed from the one decimal topline shares; group margins are differences in whole number column percentages. Party is voter file registration. Recall is a diagnostic, not a weighting target.

CONTACT

# Questions, crosstabs and media requests

Prior releases and our polling archive are posted on the website.


PREPARED BY

**Jason B. Corley**

Co-founder and Lead Pollster

Quantus Insights

EMAIL

**contact@quantusinsights.org**

WEBSITE

**quantusinsights.org**

X / TWITTER

@QuantusInsights


FIELD DATES

**October 24 to 25, 2026**